

LEVEL 2 · WRITE-UP

Star Letters

A Bayer designation names a star by a Greek letter and its constellation (for example Betelgeuse = α Orionis). The Greek letters are an ordering: $\alpha=1$, $\beta=2$, $\gamma=3$, $\delta=4$, $\epsilon=5$...

The trick: the Greek letter is a position, and it selects that letter from the constellation's name. Example:

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Gamma Orionis →  $\gamma$  = 3rd letter of ORION → I  
Alpha Persei →  $\alpha$  = 1st letter of PERSEUS → P
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Working through every entry (constellation in the genitive maps to its nominative: Orionis→ORION, Persei→PERSEUS, Cygni→CYGNUS, Tauri→TAURUS, Aquilae→AQUILA, Lyrae→LYRA, Geminorum→GEMINI, Leonis→LEO, Fornacis→FORNAX, Bootis→BOOTES, Herculis→HERCULES, Andromedae→ANDROMEDA):

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P I C T U R E → PICTURE  
O F → OF  
T H E → THE  
D A Y → DAY
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CTC{picture_of_the_day}

Note: γ Lyrae and δ Lyrae both appear here. Lyra will matter again at the very end — it was in front of the solvers all along.